

Leyna Shackleton

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Research Positions

- 07/2024 - Present **Pappalardo Postdoctoral Fellow**, *Massachusetts Institute of Technology*, Cambridge
- 01/2023 - 05/2023 **Pre-Doctoral Researcher**, *Flatiron Institute, Center for Computational Quantum Physics*, New York
Supervisor: Shiwei Zhang

Education

- 09/2018 - 05/2024 **PhD in Physics**, *Harvard University*, Cambridge
Thesis: *Fractionalization and disorder in strongly correlated systems*
Advisor: Subir Sachdev
- 09/2014 - 06/2018 **B.S's in Physics and Philosophy**, *Massachusetts Institute of Technology*, Cambridge
Thesis: *Diffusional Instabilities on Curved Manifolds*
Advisor: Mehran Kardar

Preprints

A. Feuerpfeil, **L. Shackleton**, A. Maity, R. Thomale, S. Sachdev, and Y. Iqbal, “Unifying Dirac spin liquids on square and Shastry-Sutherland lattices via fermionic deconfined criticality,” (2026), [arXiv:2601.19980](https://arxiv.org/abs/2601.19980) [cond-mat.str-el] .

G. Gyawali, **L. Shackleton**, Z.-X. Luo, and M. Lawler, “The source of hardware-tailored codes and coding phases,” (2025), [arXiv:2503.15483](https://arxiv.org/abs/2503.15483) .

L. Shackleton and S. Zhang, “Emergent polaronic correlations in doped spin liquids,” (2024), [arXiv:2408.02190](https://arxiv.org/abs/2408.02190) .

Publications

L. Shackleton, “Twisted quantum doubles are sign problem-free,” *Phys. Rev. Lett.* **136**, 186503 (2026).

Y. Zhang, **L. Shackleton**, and T. Senthil, “Pathways from a chiral superconductor to a composite fermi liquid,” *Phys. Rev. B* **113**, 144510 (2026).

A. Wietek, L. Staszewski, M. Ulaga, P. L. Ebert, H. Karlsson, S. Sarkar, **L. Shackleton**, A. Sinha, and R. D. Soares, “XDiag: Exact diagonalization for quantum many-body systems,” *SciPost Phys. Codebases* , 70 (2026).

L. Shackleton and S. Sachdev, “Sign-problem-free effective models of triangular lattice quantum antiferromagnets,” *Phys. Rev. B* **111**, 075101 (2025).

M. Christos, **L. Shackleton**, S. Sachdev, and Z.-X. Luo, “Deconfined quantum criticality of nodal d -wave superconductivity, néel order, and charge order on the square lattice at half-filling,” *Phys. Rev. Res.* **6**, 033018 (2024).

L. E. Anderson, A. Laitinen, A. Zimmerman, T. Werkmeister, **L. Shackleton**, A. Kruchkov, T. Taniguchi, K. Watanabe, S. Sachdev, and P. Kim, “Magneto-thermoelectric transport in graphene quantum dot with strong correlations,” *Phys. Rev. Lett.* **132**, 246502 (2024), (*Editor’s Suggestion*).

L. Shackleton, L. E. Anderson, P. Kim, and S. Sachdev, “Conductance and thermopower fluctuations in interacting quantum dots,” *Phys. Rev. B* **109**, 235109 (2024).

L. Shackleton and M. S. Scheurer, “Exactly solvable dissipative spin liquid,” *Phys. Rev. B* **109**, 085115 (2024), [arXiv:2307.05743](#) .

M. Christos, Z.-X. Luo, **L. Shackleton**, Y.-H. Zhang, M. S. Scheurer, and S. Sachdev, “A model of d -wave superconductivity, antiferromagnetism, and charge order on the square lattice,” *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences* **120**, e2302701120 (2023), [arXiv:2302.07885](#) .

L. Shackleton and S. Sachdev, “Anisotropic deconfined criticality in Dirac spin liquids,” *Journal of High Energy Physics* **2022**, 141 (2022), [arXiv:2203.01962](#) .

L. Shackleton, A. Thomson, and S. Sachdev, “Deconfined criticality and a gapless $\mathbb{Z}_2$ spin liquid in the square-lattice antiferromagnet,” *Phys. Rev. B* **104**, 045110 (2021), [arXiv:2104.09537](#) .

L. Shackleton, A. Wietek, A. Georges, and S. Sachdev, “Quantum phase transition at nonzero doping in a random t - J model,” *Phys. Rev. Lett.* **126**, 136602 (2021), [arXiv:2012.06589](#) .

L. Shackleton and M. S. Scheurer, “Protection of parity-time symmetry in topological many-body systems: Non-Hermitian toric code and fracton models,” *Phys. Rev. Research* **2**, 033022 (2020), [arXiv:2005.09668](#) .

Nivedita, **L. Shackleton**, and S. Sachdev, “Spectral form factors of clean and random quantum Ising chains,” *Phys. Rev. E* **101**, 042136 (2020), [arXiv:2001.06732](#) .

J. R. Frank, J. Guven, M. Kardar, and **L. Shackleton**, “Pinning of diffusional patterns by non-uniform curvature,” *Europhysics Letters* **127**, 48001 (2019), [arXiv:1901.09900](#) .

Presentations

- 10/20/2026 “Mapping the quantum limits of classical simulatability,” Center for Quantum Phenomena Seminar, NYU (upcoming)
- 09/30/2026 “Neural-Network Variational Monte Carlo for Anyons,” Artificial Intelligence at the Quantum Frontier, KITP, UC Santa Barbara [\[slides\]](#)
- 09/25/2026 “Anyonic neural quantum states,” Condensed Matter Seminar, University of Minnesota [\[slides\]](#)
- 09/24/2026 “Mapping the quantum limits of classical simulatability,” Physics Colloquium, University of Minnesota [\[slides\]](#)
- 08/24/2026 “Mapping the quantum limits of classical simulatability,” A Multicultural Approach to Fractionalization and Electronic Correlations in 2D Materials, Nordita, Stockholm [\[slides\]](#)
- 05/14/2026 “Mapping the quantum limits of classical simulatability,” Pappalardo Symposium, MIT [\[slides\]](#)
- 05/12/2026 “Mapping the quantum limits of classical simulatability,” 130th Statistical Mechanics Conference, Rutgers University [\[slides\]](#)
- 03/18/2026 “Twisted quantum doubles are sign problem-free,” APS Global Physics Summit 2026 (March Meeting), Denver
- 10/24/2025 “Twisted quantum doubles are sign problem-free,” NUS Physics Condensed Matter Series
- 09/20/2025 “Twisted quantum doubles are sign problem-free,” Condensed Matter Theory Kids’ Seminar, Harvard University
- 09/19/2025 “Twisted quantum doubles are sign problem-free,” Condensed Matter Physics Seminar, MIT
- 06/2024 “Fractionalized Fermi liquids: mean-field theories, instabilities, and variational wavefunctions,” HQI-FQSP Perspectives of Fundamental Quantum Science [\[slides\]](#)
- 06/2024 “Variational wavefunctions for fractionalized Fermi liquids,” EPiQS Postdoctoral Symposium [\[slides\]](#)
- 03/2024 “Variational wavefunctions for fractionalized Fermi liquids,” APS March Meeting 2024, contributed talk [\[slides\]](#)
- 03/2024 “Conductance and thermopower fluctuations in interacting quantum dots,” APS March Meeting 2024, invited talk [\[slides\]](#)
- 12/04/2023 “Models of deconfined criticality on square and triangular lattice antiferromagnets,” Seminar, Perimeter Institute
- 11/29/2023 “Models of deconfined criticality on square and triangular lattice antiferromagnets,” Seminar, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign [\[slides\]](#)
- 11/28/2023 “Models of deconfined criticality on square and triangular lattice antiferromagnets,” Condensed Matter Theory Kids’ Seminar, Harvard University [\[slides\]](#)

- 11/15/2023 “Sign-problem-free effective models for triangular lattice antiferromagnets,” Seminar, Flatiron Institute [\[slides\]](#)
- 06/12/2023 “An exactly solvable dissipative spin liquid,” Group Seminar, University of Innsbruck [\[slides\]](#)
- 05/23/2023 “Variational wavefunctions for the pseudogap metal,” Predoctoral Researcher Presentation, Flatiron Institute [\[slides\]](#)
- 03/10/2023 “Sign-problem-free effective models of spin-1/2 Heisenberg antiferromagnetism on the triangular lattice,” APS March Meeting 2023, contributed talk [\[slides\]](#)
- 02/08/2023 “Paramagnon fractionalization theory of the cuprate pseudogap,” Quantum Monte Carlo Seminar, Flatiron Institute [\[slides\]](#)
- 11/06/2022 “Sign-problem-free effective models of triangular lattice antiferromagnetism,” Group Seminar, Harvard University [\[slides\]](#)
- 03/17/2022 “Deconfined criticality and a gapless $\mathbb{Z}_2$ spin liquid in the square-lattice antiferromagnet,” APS March Meeting 2022, contributed talk [\[slides\]](#)
- 03/19/2021 “Protection of parity-time symmetry in topological many-body systems,” APS March Meeting 2021, contributed talk [\[slides\]](#)
- 09/21/2020 “Numerical study of the random $t - J$ model with all-to-all interactions,” Group Seminar, Harvard University [\[slides\]](#)
- 06/15/2020 “Protection of parity-time symmetry in topological many-body systems,” Group Seminar, Harvard University [\[slides\]](#)
- 06/16/2018 “Turing patterns on deformed surfaces,” Kardar-Fest, in celebration of Prof. Mehran Kardar’s 60th birthday, contributed talk [\[slides\]](#)

Posters

- 01/20/2026 “Twisted quantum doubles are sign problem-free”, Ultra Quantum Matter annual meeting
- 06/25/2022 “Deconfined criticality and a gapless $\mathbb{Z}_2$ spin liquid in the square-lattice antiferromagnet”, Correlated Electron Systems Gordon Research Conference
- 05/05/2022 “Deconfined criticality and a gapless $\mathbb{Z}_2$ spin liquid in the square-lattice antiferromagnet”, CIFAR Quantum Materials Summer School
- 07/08/2021 “Deconfined criticality and a gapless $\mathbb{Z}_2$ spin liquid in the square-lattice antiferromagnet”, IMPRS-MPHQ-BeyondC Summer School

Teaching experience

Teaching fellow at Harvard University for:

09/2022 - 12/2022 Physics 195A (Introduction to Solid State Physics)

01/2022 - 05/2022 Physics 153 (Electrodynamics)

01/2021 - 05/2021 Physics 153 (Electrodynamics)

Responsibilities: Recitation and review sessions (2 hours per week), office hours (2 hours per week)

Head teaching assistant at Massachusetts Institute of Technology for:

09/2017 - 12/2017 8.13 (Experimental Physics 1)

Responsibilities: Assisted students in conducting experiments (4 hours per week)